

GETTY IMAGES



VOLLEYBALL

TOTAL MEDALS AT STAKE

6

Indian contingent



Men's team — Chirag, Amit, Muthusamy Appavu, Jerome Vinith, Muhammad Nihal Chatham Kulangara, John Joseph Eanthungal Joseph, Joel Benjamin Jebaraj, Anand Kottarathil, Om Vasant Lad, Ashwal Rai, Shikhar Singh, Erin Varghese (in pic)

India's performance in men's volleyball at the Asian Games in Hangzhou in 2023 was a major highlight, with the side finishing sixth. The run included stunning wins over higher-ranked South Korea and Chinese Taipei.

Unfortunately, administrative and governance issues in the sport prevented the team from getting closer to the world's elite.

The side did show promise at this year's AVC Cup in Ahmedabad, finishing third, and fought hard in defeats to China and Iran at this month's AVC Volleyball Continental Championship.

India has one silver and two bronze medals at the Asiad, but none since Seoul in 1986. That wait for another podium finish is likely to continue.

SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT



RUGBY SEVENS

Indian contingent



Women's team — Amandeep Kaur, Guriya Kumari, Ujjwala Ghuge, Parbati Hansdah, Arti Kumari, Dumuni Marndi, Vaishnavi Patil, Kalyani Patil, Sandhya Rai, Nirmalya Rout, Bhumika Shukla, Sandhyarani Tudu, Shikha Yadav

Rugby sevens has been part of the Asian Games since 1998, but the women's competition made its debut 12 years later. The Indian women's side competed in the inaugural edition of the women's event and again in 2023, finishing seventh on both occasions.

The team recently took part in the 12-nation Asia Rugby Sevens Series in China, where it finished sixth (in pic).

A podium finish at the Asian Games looks unlikely on the third try as well.

TOTAL MEDALS AT STAKE

6